

Purpose

Emphasizes going from the open position to throwing the ball.

Setup

The pitcher stands about 20 feet from the catcher.



Player learning to go from the open position to throwing the ball.

Instructions

1. The pitcher starts in the open position with her glove shoulder high and pointed toward the target, and the ball over her head.
2. She goes through her motion, bringing the glove in and swinging the ball back, down, and then toward the plate.
3. She throws the ball to the catcher.

Coaching Tips

- When running this drill, you can have the pitcher use just her arms on the throw or drag her back foot up on the follow-through.

- As the pitcher gets better and more used to running this drill, you can add a stride step to the beginning to help improve her rhythm.
- Toward the end of the motion, the pitcher (right-handed) should drive the right leg into the left leg as fast as possible – this helps prevent leaning and getting off balance.

Tips for Younger Athletes:

- Focus on keeping the glove shoulder pointed directly at the target during the entire motion to improve accuracy.
- Remind players to keep their fingers on top of the ball throughout the arm circle for better control.
- If balance is an issue, use a small marker or cone to guide them in dragging their back foot straight forward during the motion.

Tips for Older Athletes:

- Emphasize maintaining a consistent and fast arm circle speed to maximize velocity without losing control.
- Encourage players to focus on wrist snap at release to increase spin and movement on the ball.
- Reinforce finishing the motion balanced and in an athletic position, ready to field a ball, to build good habits for game situations.